

DENDRITIC CELL THERAPY IN CANCERS

Long ago, it became clear that for cancer to occur the immune system must have failed. The normal immune system recognizes and kills the mutating cancerous cells. During the last decade there is a rapidly increasing understanding of immune surveillance and appreciation of the mechanisms by which tumors escape its notice. This has led to the development of promising new strategies against cancer, of which the most exciting and consistently successful are dendritic cell therapy vaccines. In dendritic cell therapy the goal is to train the person's immune system to recognize and kill cancer cells.

Each one of us has a tendency to form cancer cells during normal process of cell division. When a cell transforms into a cancerous (mutated) cell, it comes under the scrutiny of our immune surveillance. It is the dendritic cell which helps in the process of recognition of this cancer cell and assist in its killing. This mechanism of immune surveillance fails in a person with cancer. The dendritic cell therapy helps in correcting the defect and teaches the immune system to recognize and kill cancer cells.

Dendritic cell therapy is an allopathic treatment and comes under the heading of immunotherapy, considered the fourth, rapidly emerging therapy in cancer, in addition to surgery, chemotherapy and radiation therapy. This therapy can be used alone as well as in combination with standard therapy. While chemotherapy alone also leads to spontaneous remission in a few cases, it is the revival of immunology that causes this.

Dendritic cell therapy being more targeted is less toxic. Designed to be specific it targets only the cancer cells without harming the healthy ones. It also helps prevent tumor recurrence after surgery, radiation, or chemotherapy because the immune system will need to recognize and attack a smaller number of cancer cells.

The Institute of Cellular Therapies (ICT), the first of its kind in India, offers Dendritic cell therapy cancer vaccines. Our experience of three years in clinical practice involves administering of this therapy to numerous patients suffering from various types of solid tumors, mostly in advanced stages. The results range from an increase in the median survival to complete remission. The treatment helps in making a difference in extending life and maintaining a good quality of life. At the Institute of Cellular Therapies, each treatment plan and each dendritic cancer vaccine is customized to the person with cancer. A number of hospitals world over are already into this treatment modality.

The Institute of Cellular Therapies works with the aim to provide more comprehensive individualized programs to help people with cancer overcome their disease.



ICT

Nurturing Cells for Lives

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